Caffeine Citrate Intravenous

NOTE: Take special care calculating doses and administration volumes. A ten times overdose could prove fatal.

Neonatal

FORM Ampoule containing 20mg/ml caffeine citrate solution for infusion

PRESCRIBE AS CAFFEINE CITRATE

INDICATION

1) Treatment and prophylaxis of apnoea of prematurity
2) Prevention of bronchopulmonary dysplasia

DOSE RANGE

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Neonate - 6 months	20mg/kg	**STAT LOADING DOSE**	IV
Neonate - 6 months	10mg/kg	Once daily **MAINTENANCE** *	IV

- *Commence maintenance dose 24 hours after loading dose
- Consider 10mg/kg twice daily dosing when on concomitant enzyme inducing drugs e.g. phenobarbital.
- Infants over 28 days old who are still apnoeic should benefit from maintenance caffeine doses administered twice daily.

RECONSTITUTION Already in solution

DILUTION Further dilution is not required, however may be diluted with a suitable volume of compatible solution to aid administration (see table below)

METHOD OF ADMINISTRATION Slow IV bolus injection over 3–5 minutes*, via a central line if possible

***IV bolus administration is unlicensed and is based on historical practice with the WoS. Where there are concerns regarding tachycardia, consider extended administration time of 10-30 minutes.**

COMPATIBILITY

Solution compatibility	Glucose 5%, Sodium Chloride 0.9%
Solution incompatibility	TPN
IV Line compatibility	No information
IV Line incompatibility	Aciclovir, furosemide

THIS LIST IS NOT EXHAUSTIVE PLEASE CONTACT PHARMACY FOR FURTHER INFORMATION ON COMPATIBILITY WITH ANY MEDICINES NOT INCLUDED

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children

Review dose if tachyardia occurs.

FURTHER INFORMATION

- Caution in impaired renal or hepatic function
- Slow IV bolus is an unlicensed but widely accepted method of administration
- Caffeine citrate 2mg = caffeine base 1mg
- Extravasation is likely to cause tissue damage due to low pH
- See summary of product characteristics for signs of toxicity

LICENSED STATUS

Off-label use of licensed product

APPLICABLE POLICIES

West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines:

Consult local policy if applicable

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Prepared By/Checked By:	Frances Lowrie/Andrew Stockton/Susan Kafka	Final Approval By:	WoS Neonatal Pharmacist Group
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Administer reconstituted solutions immediately.
All vials, ampoules and infusion bags are for single use only unless otherwise stated.

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice please contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department